

3.8.2 Marking criteria

3.8.2.1 Guidance on applying the marking criteria

Level of response marking instructions are broken down into levels, each of which has a descriptor. The descriptor for the level shows the average performance for the level.

Before you apply the mark scheme to a student's media product, review the product and annotate it and/or make notes on it to show the qualities that are being looked for. You can then apply the marking criteria.

Start at the lowest level of the marking criteria and use it as a ladder to see whether the product meets the descriptor for that level. The descriptor for the level indicates the different qualities that might be seen in the student's product for that level. If it meets the lowest level then go to the next one and decide if it meets this level, and so on, until you have a match between the level descriptor and the product.

You can compare your student's product with the standardisation examples to determine if it is the same standard, better or worse.

When assigning a level you should look at the overall quality of the product. If the product covers different aspects of different levels of the mark scheme you should use a best fit approach for defining the level and then use the variability of the product to help decide the mark within the level, ie if the product is predominantly level 3 with a small amount of level 4 material it would be placed in level 3 but be awarded a mark near the top of the level because of the level 4 content.

No marks will be awarded for an answer containing nothing worthy of credit.

If a student only submits a Statement of Intent with no accompanying media product then this should be awarded a mark of zero.

If a student creates an audio-visual product that is longer than the stipulated duration then you should only mark the work that falls within the time limit.

If a student creates a print or online product that exceeds the stipulated length or amount then you should mark all of the pages and only give credit for the best pages up to the number of pages stipulated in the brief.

If a product is shorter than the stipulated size or duration then no penalty is to be applied as the work is likely to be self-penalising – particularly in relation to the [Production: Effectiveness in communicating meaning to an audience](#) (page 27) section.

If a student has used any non-original images, footage or text, or has failed to clearly demonstrate how they directed the activity of any unassessed participants in the media product then they should

not be awarded marks above Level 2 in the [Production: Effectiveness in communicating meaning to an audience](#) (page 27) section of the marking criteria.

3.8.2.2 Statement of intent

In this section students will be awarded marks for their response to the brief and their ability to communicate their knowledge and understanding of language and representation to the reader.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• An outstanding, detailed statement that refers directly and effectively to the intended uses of media language and representations. • The intentions outlined in the statement are consistently appropriate to the brief and target the intended audience in a clear and direct way. • Excellent evidence of the application of knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework of media through extensive and sustained use of relevant and accurate subject specific terminology.
4	7–8	• A detailed statement that demonstrates the intended uses of media language and representations. • The intentions outlined in the statement are almost always appropriate to the brief and target the intended audience. • Good evidence of the application of knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework of media through frequent use of relevant and accurate subject specific terminology.
3	5–6	• A clear statement that demonstrates some intended uses of media language and some intended aspects of representation. • The intentions outlined in the statement are generally appropriate to the brief and target the intended audience in a satisfactory way. • Satisfactory evidence of the application of knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework of media through some use of relevant and accurate subject specific terminology.
2	3–4	• The statement makes occasional reference to intended uses of media language and/or occasional intended aspects of representation. • The intentions outlined in the statement are inconsistently appropriate to the brief and only sometimes target the intended audience. • Basic evidence of the application of knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework of media through very little use of relevant and accurate subject specific terminology.

		• The intentions outlined in the statement are unlikely to be appropriate to the brief and have minimal sense of the intended audience. • Minimal evidence of the application of knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework of media in which any attempt to use subject specific terminology is likely to be inaccurate.
	0	Nothing worthy of credit.

3.8.2.3 Production: Media Language

In this section students will be rewarded for the degree of expertise they demonstrate in using media language within the chosen media form.

Level	Marks	Description
5	13–15	• Excellent application of knowledge and understanding of media language, demonstrated by the consistently appropriate and effective selection and combination of elements to communicate very clear meanings throughout the product. • An excellent and compelling product that constructs very effective narratives and shows deliberate control of connotations and clearly and purposefully constructs points of view.
4	10–12	• Good application of knowledge and understanding of media language, demonstrated by the frequently appropriate and effective selection and combination of elements to communicate clear meanings throughout the product. • A good product that constructs effective narratives and shows some deliberate control of connotations though this may not be throughout and constructs points of view.
3	7–9	• Satisfactory application of knowledge and understanding of media language, demonstrated by the generally appropriate but inconsistently effective selection and combination of straightforward elements to communicate generally clear meanings throughout the product. • A satisfactory product that constructs suitable narratives and shows occasional control of connotations but rarely constructs points of view.
2	4–6	• Basic application of knowledge and understanding of media language, demonstrated by the occasionally appropriate selection and combination of simple elements to communicate basic meanings. • A basic product that constructs simple narratives and shows little awareness of connotations.

		language, demonstrated by little appropriate selection and combination of very simple elements to communicate very limited meanings. • A minimal product that shows little awareness of narrative.
	0	Nothing worthy of credit.

3.8.2.4 Production: Representation

In this section students will be rewarded for their ability to understand and create representations in the chosen media form.

Level	Marks	Description
5	13–15	• Excellent application of knowledge and understanding of media representations, demonstrated by the consistently effective use or subversion of stereotypes and/or stereotypical representations that are highly appropriate to the audience, form and genre. • Excellent use of media representations to communicate clear and highly appropriate meanings throughout.
4	10–12	• Good application of knowledge and understanding of media representations, demonstrated by the frequently effective use or subversion of stereotypes and/or stereotypical representations that are appropriate to the audience, form and genre. • Good use of media representations to communicate appropriate meanings throughout.
3	7–9	• Satisfactory application of knowledge and understanding of media representations, demonstrated by the sometimes effective use or subversion of stereotypes and/or stereotypical representations that are generally appropriate to the audience, form and genre though there are likely to be some inconsistencies. • Satisfactory use of media representations to communicate generally appropriate meanings though this is unlikely to be throughout the product.
2	4–6	• Basic application of knowledge and understanding of media representations, demonstrated by the rarely effective use of stereotypes and/or stereotypical representations that are only occasionally appropriate to the audience, form and genre. • Basic use of media representations to communicate only occasionally appropriate meanings.

		representations, demonstrated by a lack of appropriate use of stereotypes and/or stereotypical representations that are very rarely appropriate to the audience, form or genre. Minimal use of media representations to communicate very little discernible meaning.
	0	Nothing worthy of credit.

3.8.2.5 Production: Effectiveness in communicating meaning to an audience

In this section students will be rewarded for how well their media product communicates meanings and whether or not they have met the requirements stipulated in the brief. Teachers/assessors are to use their professional judgement rather than looking for evidence of testing the product on a live audience.

Level	Marks	Description
5	17–20	- An excellent product that would successfully engage the designated audience by employing a consistently effective and appropriate mode of address throughout. - An excellent product that extensively uses highly relevant codes and conventions of the form and genre consistently. - Meets all the requirements of the brief and completes all of the tasks fully.
4	13–16	- A good product that would interest the designated audience by employing a frequently effective and appropriate mode of address throughout. - A good product that uses generally relevant codes and conventions of the form and genre. - Meets almost all the requirements of the brief and almost all of the tasks are completed.
3	9–12	- A satisfactory product that would be of some interest to the designated audience by employing a sometimes effective and appropriate mode of address throughout. - A satisfactory product that uses codes and conventions of the form and genre inconsistently. - Meets the main requirements of the brief and most of the tasks are completed but some of the details are missing.
2	5–8	- A basic product that would only be of occasional interest to the designated audience by employing a mode of address that is only occasionally effective or appropriate. - A basic product that uses codes and conventions of the form and genre inconsistently. - Meets some of the requirements of the brief but only a few of the tasks have been completed and it may fall below the specified length/duration.

		designated audience and has little sense of mode of address. • A minimal product that only very rarely uses codes and conventions of the form and genre. • Meets very few of the requirements of the brief and it is likely to fall well below the specified length/duration. For marks towards the top of this band this must be, at least, a recognisable media product.
	0	Nothing worthy of credit.